Geoff DeFrance

NASHVILLE, TN | GEOFFDEFRANCE.COM | LINKEDIN.COM/IN/GEOFFDEFRANCE

Product & Engineering Leader | AI-Native Delivery & Governance | Consumer Web & Apps at Scale | Subscription Media & Streaming

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Product & Engineering executive with 20+ years scaling subscription, streaming, telecom, and ad-tech businesses for Yahoo!, Discovery/Motor Trend, Opry Entertainment, Cox Automotive/Kelley Blue Book, Uniti Group, and FloSports. Builds and leads high-performing, AI-enabled Product, Design, and Engineering organizations, pairing rigorous product discovery with disciplined execution to drive KPI and revenue growth. Currently running an entire product and engineering function through AI-orchestrated delivery with defined human control gates. Customer-centric change agent who partners across the executive team to align strategy, accelerate delivery, and scale teams through growth and transformation.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product & Strategy Product Strategy & Vision · Product Discovery (SVPG) · M&A / Digital Transformation · P&L & Budget Management ($17M+)

AI & Delivery AI-Enabled Product Development · AI-Orchestrated Delivery & Governance · Agile/Scrum Delivery at Scale · Data-Driven Decision Making

Growth & Platform Direct-to-Consumer (DTC) Growth · Subscription / SVOD / OTT Streaming · eCommerce Conversion Optimization · eCommerce Replatforming & Migration · AB Testing & Experimentation · Martech & Platform Modernization

Experience & Organization Design Systems & UX · Customer Insights, Retention & NPS · Cross-Functional Executive Partnership · Org Design & Team Scaling (75+ FTEs)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DeFrance & Co. Nashville, TN **Jul 2026 – Present**

Founder, Head of Product & Engineering

*Led product and technology for an AI-driven full **CMS and front-end** e-commerce replatform/redesign as a one-person organization for a specialty foods retailer, using Anthropic Claude (cloud design & development sandbox, browser-based inspection, persistent project knowledge) as the delivery team. Delivered the replatform end to end in 6–8 weeks; now in growth mode.*

- Ran every release through explicit human control gates — a written specification before each build, validation in an isolated cloud sandbox, deployment by a human operator only, and AI browser access kept read-only so no automated write could reach production — and shipped 40+ releases under that model, each checked against the live site after deploy.
- Separated generation from verification across independent AI surfaces, validating every change against the live rendered DOM post-deploy rather than trusting the build as written.

Uniti Group, Inc. (NASDAQ: UNIT; formerly Windstream, Inc.) Nashville, TN **Aug 2023 – Feb 2026**

VP, Digital Product Experience

Led Product Management, Design, and SEO for Kinetic, the consumer fiber brand of Uniti ($3B+ 2025 run-rate revenue), serving 1.8M+ households across 21 states; managed a team of 8 (5 PMs, 2 designers, 1 SEO/AEO/GEO specialist) and a 2M+ USD expense budget; reported to the CMO and CRO.

- Grew DTC eCommerce sales 80%+ YoY on a 48% YoY increase in conversion rate, beating forecast and board-plan conversion goals by 10–20%.
- Led the full redesign of gokinetic.com (formerly windstream.com), and ran dozens of A/B tests a year with lifts of up to 20% per test.

- Migrated the marketing technology stack to a headless CMS (Contentful), new analytics, SEO, and A/B testing tools; built AI into prototyping and copy generation, and ran parallel product discovery and delivery.
- Carried Kinetic's digital experience through the Windstream–Uniti merger and its first six months, owning all DTC acquisition KPIs throughout.

FloSports, Inc. (PE-Backed) Austin, TX **Apr 2021 – Mar 2023**

SVP, Product & Engineering

Led a 79-person Product, Design, Engineering, Program Management, and QA org across web, iOS/tvOS, Android, Roku, and Fire TV for a 750K+ subscriber SVOD/OTT platform spanning 26 sports verticals.

- Delivered 49% YoY revenue growth ($80M to 120M+ USD) by growing the B2C subscriber base 74% (400K to 750K+) and increasing ad revenue 42% (7M to 11M+ USD).
- Grew YoY traffic 24% (40M+ to 50M+ unique visitors) and page views from 550M to 680M, with no increase to Product/Design headcount and only a ~10% increase to Engineering headcount.
- Built product vision, strategy, and roadmap from a first-100-days org and tech-stack assessment; introduced SVPG-based discovery and delivery practices across 11 teams.
- Earned the highest eNPS of any org in the company (+54) while managing a $17M+ annual expense budget.

Circle Media (Opry Entertainment / Ryman Hospitality, Inc.; NYSE: RHP) Nashville, TN **May 2019 – Apr 2021**

SVP, Product & Engineering

Employee #2; built the Circle FAST/CTV channel and DTC SVOD service for 46M+ country music and lifestyle enthusiasts, leading a 21-person Product, Design, Engineering, and QA team.

- Launched the FAST/CTV product to The Roku Channel, Samsung TV Plus, Vizio, and Peacock via the Amagi platform.
- Delivered a full SVOD/OTT app suite across web, iOS/tvOS, Android, Fire TV, and Roku within the first year.

Motor Trend Group (Discovery, NASDAQ: WBD; PE-Backed) El Segundo, CA **May 2011 – Apr 2018**

SVP, Product & Engineering, Head of Digital (progressed from Director → VP → SVP)

Rose through four promotions over seven years to lead a 76-person digital organization across 40+ automotive brands; scaled Motor Trend OnDemand, the industry's largest automotive DTC subscription streaming service.

- Early in this tenure, led the product management team through a full redesign of key car-research properties following a severe Google algorithm penalty (Panda I), repairing strained legacy stakeholder relationships and restoring both search traffic and cross-functional trust.
- Recruited and managed a team of 21 Product Managers, Designers, and Researchers; improved agile/Scrum velocity and process by 25% while right-sizing development team ratios across the automotive brand portfolio.
- Grew MotorTrend.com traffic 136% following an award-winning full-stack redesign and platform migration (CMS, AWS, CDN); reduced churn 50% and increased NPS ~40 points.
- Grew Motor Trend OnDemand from zero to 200K+ subscribers in 18 months ($10M+ new revenue), a catalyst for Discovery's 2017 majority-ownership acquisition of the company.
- Managed all web and mobile app product experiences and monetization — a combined 60M+ page views/month, 12M+ unique visitors, and $40M+ in revenue — across ad-supported and subscription (SVOD/OTT) product lines.
- Consolidated 40+ automotive domains into seven "Super Site" properties, improving traffic and engagement 50% at a lower cost profile.
- Reduced department operating expenses 40% ($20M to 12M USD) in under two years while scaling the team and modernizing the architecture.

EARLIER CAREER

Kelley Blue Book (Cox Automotive) Irvine, CA **2010 – 2011**

Director of Product Management

- Drove 12M+ monthly visits to kbb.com, one of the automotive industry's highest-traffic B2C properties, leading a 4-person Product Management team.

- Owned the kbb.com roadmap, balancing ad-revenue monetization goals against overall audience experience and engagement KPIs.
- Delivered consistently successful releases through regular AB testing, well-prioritized backlogs, and data-driven decision frameworks.

Yahoo! Sunnyvale, CA **2003 – 2010**

Sr. Product Manager, Display & Search Advertising Platforms

- Led product management (up to 6 direct reports) across Yahoo!'s B2B search and display advertising platforms, including the $1.8B display migration to Project APT and the USD 5.2B B2B search marketing platform.
- Directed machine-learning-enabled editorial review systems — pairing algorithmic and human review to assess 200M+ search ads and tens of thousands of display ads monthly across 20+ countries at a 95%+ ML automation rate.
- Drove product discovery, definition, and roadmap for Yahoo!'s first-ever global B2B campaign-management application (YSM Desktop) and launched B2B advertiser products across 20 countries.

EDUCATION & TECHNICAL FLUENCY

B.S., International Business — San Francisco State University

AI (hands-on): Anthropic Claude — agentic development sandbox, browser-based verification, persistent project knowledge; OpenAI | AI adopted across teams under my leadership: Figma Make, v0 | Jira, Confluence, Contentful, Segment, MixPanel, FullStory, Adobe/Google Analytics, Tableau, Optimizely, VWO, AWS, Azure, React/React Native